Doctor Visit Checklist

For osteopenia and osteoporosis · From Lisa Pocius, MD

> Print this, fill in what you can before your appointment, and bring it with you. These are questions to ask, not medical advice. Your own doctor knows your full story and is the right person to guide your care.

What to Bring

- [ ] A list of every medication and supplement you take. Include doses, and medicines you've taken long-term in the past. Steroid pills or shots like prednisone count, including past short courses for things like asthma or poison ivy. If you've had several, list them all.
- [ ] Copies of all your past DEXA reports, not just the latest one. Comparing scans over time shows the trend. Results are easiest to compare when they come from the same machine and the same body site.
- [ ] Your fracture history. Every broken bone as an adult, how it happened, and your age at the time.
- [ ] A list of any falls in the past year, even ones where you didn't get hurt.
- [ ] Your family history. Note parents, grandparents, or siblings with osteoporosis, a broken hip, height loss, or a curved upper back.
- [ ] Any height loss you've noticed. Bring your tallest adult height if you know it.
- [ ] Any recent lab results, such as a vitamin D level.
- [ ] Your questions, written down. Circle the three that matter most to you, in case time runs short.

Questions for Your First Visit

MY DIAGNOSIS

- [ ] What are my T-scores at each site? Does my Z-score matter for someone my age, and what does it tell you?
- [ ] Do I have osteopenia or osteoporosis? Does a past fracture change that?

MY FRACTURE RISK

- [ ] What's my FRAX score, my 10-year risk of a major fracture and of a hip fracture?
- [ ] Would FRAXplus or a TBS (trabecular bone score) give a better picture in my case?

OTHER CAUSES

- [ ] Could another condition or a medication be adding to my bone loss?
- [ ] Which blood tests will you order? For example, vitamin D, calcium, kidney function, thyroid, and parathyroid hormone.

TREATMENT

- [ ] Do you recommend medication? If so, which one, and why that one for me?
- [ ] How well does it work for someone with my numbers, and what are the common and the rare side effects?
- [ ] How long would I take it, and what happens when I stop?
- [ ] If you don't recommend medication, or if I decline medication, what's the plan, and when will we recheck my bone density?

DAILY LIFE

- [ ] What exercise is safe for me, and which movements should I avoid? Would physical therapy help?
- [ ] How much calcium, vitamin D, and protein should I aim for, and should most of it come from food?
- [ ] What can I do to lower my risk of falling?

DENTAL WORK AND NEXT STEPS

- [ ] Should I see my dentist or finish any dental work before I start a medication?
- [ ] When should I have my next DEXA scan, and should it be on the same machine?

Questions for Follow-Up Visits

- [ ] How has my scan changed since last time, at each site? Is that a real change, or within the machine's normal range of variation?
- [ ] Is my treatment working the way you hoped?
- [ ] Are my side effects something to watch, or a reason to change medications?
- [ ] How long should I stay on this medication?
- [ ] Am I a candidate for a drug holiday (a planned break from treatment)? Breaks are mainly for bisphosphonates, so is that safe with my medication?
- [ ] If I'm on Prolia or another denosumab shot, such as Jubbonti, what's the plan for when I stop, so I don't lose bone quickly? What happens if a dose is late?
- [ ] Have my labs changed? Do any need rechecking?
- [ ] What's the next step, and when should I come back?

My Visit Notes

Date of visit _____ **Doctor** _____

MY NUMBERS

Site	T-score	Z-score	Change since last scan
Lumbar spine			
Total hip (circle: left, right, both)			
Femoral neck (circle: left, right, both)			
Forearm (if measured)			
Other site			

FRAX 10-year risk: major fracture _____ % **hip fracture** _____ %

TBS or FRAXplus, if done _____

My height today _____ **ft** _____ **in (** _____ **cm)** **Tallest adult height** _____ **ft** _____ **in (** _____ **cm)**

1 foot = 12 inches = 30.48 cm; 1 inch = 2.54 cm

Labs ordered and results

What my doctor said

Medications started, stopped, or changed (name, dose, how often)

Exercise and safety advice I was given

Next DEXA scan _____ **Next appointment** _____

Questions to ask next time

For more plain-language guidance, see my book, **Osteoporosis: The Book I Wish I'd Had When I Was Diagnosed**, and free articles at mybone.health.

For education only, not a substitute for advice from your own doctor. © 2026 Lisa Pocius, MD